The Last Supper, or the Dead Waiter

By John Stewart

The lack of information and interpretation concerning the life and times of Jesus Christ has, for years, frustrated scholars, theologians and lovers of information and interpretation. To date, the only notable published material on the subject is Franz Shecter's thorough yet ambiguous dissertation, "That Guy from the Thing." So little is known of Jesus because, as Shecter asserts, "He died a long time ago."

The virtual blackout has recently been lifted, in light of an astonishing discovery in the Sinai Peninsula. What is to date the only written account pertaining to the existence of Jesus Christ has been found. The manuscript contains explicitly reference to a dinner party Jesus had with twelve male friends. It is an eye-

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witness account penned by Avram the Waiter, who served the Christ party at the then-popular Jerusalem eatery, Jerry's.

INTRODUCTION

The Last Supper, or the Dead Waiterby John Stewart . . . This is The Manuscript of "Avram the Waiter"

So much for things being slow during Passover. It was April of 33 and as usual Jerry's was jammed. Jerry's was the "in" spot of the moment. Ever since Pilate started coming here the place has been packed with gawkers and wannabes. Personally, I could care less. You're a person, I'm a person. Doesn't matter if you're Augustus or Barabbas. You treat me with respect, you get good service. Anyway, I'm at the end of an eight-hour double, slopping kishke to drunken centurions, and in walks Jesus with his flock of hangers-on. "Here comes trouble," I say to Moishe the barback. We'd all seen Jesus and his little bunch of frat boys around town and

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believe me, not impressed. The Greeks invented a lot of great things- namely naked wrestling- but fraternities, or any other platonic organizations for that matter, weren't one of them.

So Luke, he's the skinny one with the greasy hair- oops, that's all of them- Luke says to me with a snotty attitude, "Table for thirteen…I believe it's under Christ." So I check the book. "Well, I can't find your reservation and besides, it looks like there's only eight of you here," I say to him. I'm telling the truth, by the way, not just being pissy. They didn't have a reservation and even if they did, I can't seat them if the whole party hasn't shown. Sorry, but it's not my rule. "They're coming. They'll be here. They got a little hung up. Holiday traffic," Luke says. You're kidding! Hung up in traffic? Well, that changes everything…please. Anyway, the guy's just checking out the scene, not even looking me in the eye. So all I say is, and Moishe will back me up on this, "You're welcome to hang out in the bar and wait

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for them…But I'm afraid-" and boom, he's on me. "Wait in the bar? You want us to wait in the bar. We're not waiting in the bar, little man." The way he was carrying on you'd have thought I asked him to bathe. (P.S. If Jesus is right and there is an afterlife, I hope they've got soap).

"Let me ask you something. What year is it?" Luke says. I know what he's going for but I play dumb. "What do you mean?" I ask innocently. You should have seen me, all wide-eyed and sheepish. Elijah caught my performance and said he was going to throw me a graduation party because it was obvious I no longer needed acting classes. "33 A.D." Luke says. I just let it hang there. "Anno Domini?...Year of the Lord," he says, giving the head nod over in Christ's direction. "You got me?" he says. So I turn to him real cool and go, "Well last time I checked my calendar it was still 3706." And then I snap my fingers and go back to marrying ketchups. Luke's jaw about hit the floor. Moishe turns and says, "Bathsheba

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one, Luke zero." It was really funny, but I wasn't just being a bitch. A lot of folks at Jerry's did still use the Hebrew calendar. And besides, with that attitude, those boys weren't' getting any special treatment from me. Jesus slips his tunic over his head just like the rest of us; I don't care who his father is.

I do have to admit I was a little scared. Some of these apostles are pretty rough trade, the blue-collar Nazareth crowd. And I think the others work out. They were pissed. Luke was yelling at me, saying if they don't get their table right away, Jesus would turn all our Chateau Lafite-Rothschild into low-grade zinfandel. "Do it!" I say. It's not like it's my wine.

Jesus' boys are in a bit of a frenzy, giving me the third degree. "What's your name?" "We want to talk to the manager!" "Fine," I say, "talk to the manager. Get me fired." I'm an artisan/poet. I'm putting up a night of spoken word in three weeks. I don't need to take shit

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from cult members. I should have gotten the Etruscan bouncer, Vito the Unreasonable. He'd have thrown them out on their apostles. So just as I'm about to hurl some sea salt in Peter's face, Jesus pipes up. "Boys," he says. "Please. The wise builder doesn't build on sand, but the foolish builder can't build on rock." I had no idea what he was talking about, but suddenly, the angry mob's all kittens and puppies. It's "Right, Rabbi." "Sorry, Rabbi." "Couldn't' have put it better myself, Teacher." Please! They're so affected. Jesus could have said, "Hey, look at me, I've got a banana up my ass!" and they would've acted like they just heard the word of God.

Finally, everybody shows up. It's nine o'clock. It's my last table, and the kitchen wants to close. So lucky me has to try and wrangle their order. It ain't easy. Matthew "has" to sit next to Jesus but John is having none of it, because his birthday's Monday and Jesus promised. Simon's blowing into his hand and pretending he farted. Mark and James are pouting because I

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carded them. Thomas wants a Caesar salad but doesn't believe it when I tell him you can hardly taste the anchovies in the dressing. Paul says he's lactose intolerant and claims if there's sour cream in his borscht, it's coming out of my tip. Judas sits glowering because no one will split and appetizer with him, and the rest of them just giggle at my ASK ME ABOUT OUR KUGEL! button. The way they behaved, I should have made them order off the children's menu.

If my ex-roommate hadn't just screwed me on last month's rent, believe me, I would've walked. I needed the shekels, but obviously none of these guys had ever waited tables. One of them actually snapped his fingers at me for a water refill. Not even to drink. He wanted to wash Jesus' feet! That's right, feet. Right at the table! It was enough to make Caligula nauseous. The only bev they ordered, one glass of house red. They all split it. Hello! Misers, party of thirteen.

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At this point, I think they saw I was getting pissed and realized I would be handling their food. If you think that kind of thing doesn't happen in good restaurants all the time, you're kidding yourself. We had a bartender, Isaac, who had a special drink recipe for rude customers. I'll give you a hint: The magic ingredient is yak piss. You think I'm lying? He's a Bedouin and believe me those people could give a shit.

After I got them settled down, everyone ordered the lamb, except for John, who'd had Lamb for lunch. You'd have thought we were feeding the lions the way they attacked that thing. I hope Jesus is planning some commandments on table manners. Anyway, we got through dinner but you can be sure I had Carlos prepare a fatty cut, even though they asked for lean.

As far as Jesus goes, we'd all hear about the miracles he performs, but he actually seemed pretty normal. I've had friends who get a little success and immediately

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turn into assholes, but he was cool about it. My friend's sister caught him when he did two nights in Thebes. She said it was okay. He bent some spoons and guessed that one guy in the audience was thinking about changing jobs, but she said he was better when he was still with the Lepers. Jesus definitely did no miracles at his dinner, although one of the waiters who got his autograph said it cleared up his sinuses. No real pearls of wisdom either. Once, right before dessert, Jesus said to no one in particular, "Why do people park on a driveway and drive on a parkway?" It was kind of funny. Truthfully, Jesus spent most of the time asking people whether or not a beard would make him look smarter. There was a bit of a scuffle when Paul liked the idea but Judas thought it was trendy. I say cut the hair. Please. You're not a musician and it's very B.C.

Personally, when I found out one of those guys had betrayed Jesus, it didn't surprise me a bit. You can ask David son of Phil. I told him that night, "I would not

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trust these guys if I were Jesus." It's so obvious they're not really his friends. They're just hanging around him because he's famous. You should have seen them scatter when I brought the bill. "Can you cover me, Jesus?" "I'll get you next time, Jesus." "I gotta go drain the staff, Jesus!" I don't know how the Jesus puts up with it. Poor guy probably had to walk on water just to get some peace and quiet.

Not that it kept me up nights. Let's face it. Messiahs come and go. Just last week I had a creep on table five who claimed that if I followed him, I would enjoy eternal joy in a place called Utah. He said I could have as many wives as I wanted but not caffeine. Get real. Me? Choose women over coffee? Please. Still, I was sorry to hear what happened to Jesus. He was a good tipper.

Editor's note: After this piece was published it was brought to our attention that Avram's manuscript is not the only document pertaining to the life and times of

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Jesus Christ. A work titled "The New Testament" was sent to our offices along with a large number of other pertinent volumes. We regret this oversight. Also, upon great scholarly review, Avram's manuscript was found to be written in Magic Marker, an implement not discovered until the early nineteen hundred and fifties. Again, our regrets.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: John Stewart
Book: Naked Pictures of Famous People
ISBN: 978-0688171629
Publisher: Harper Collins
Date (Month/Year): Oct 1999

AWARD HISTORY

2003 National Qualifier

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